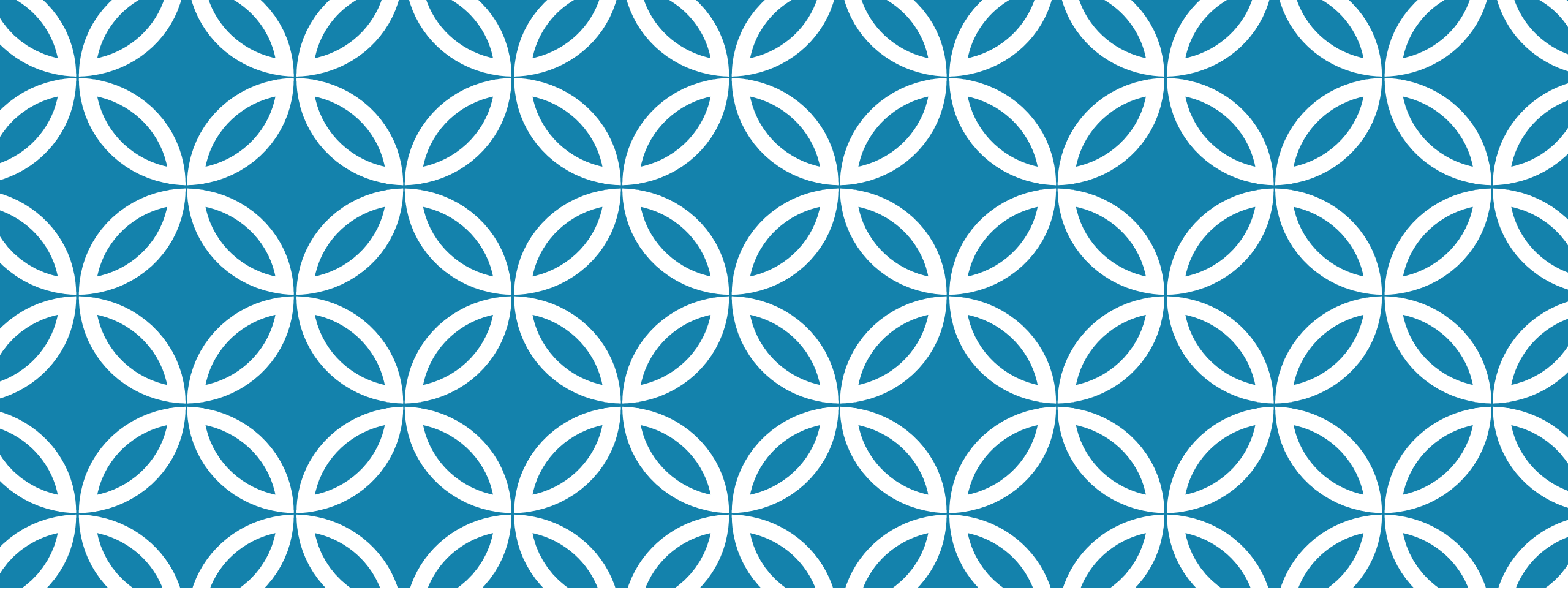


WRITING WELL-STRUCTURED PARAGRAPHS

Academic Writing Fundamentals

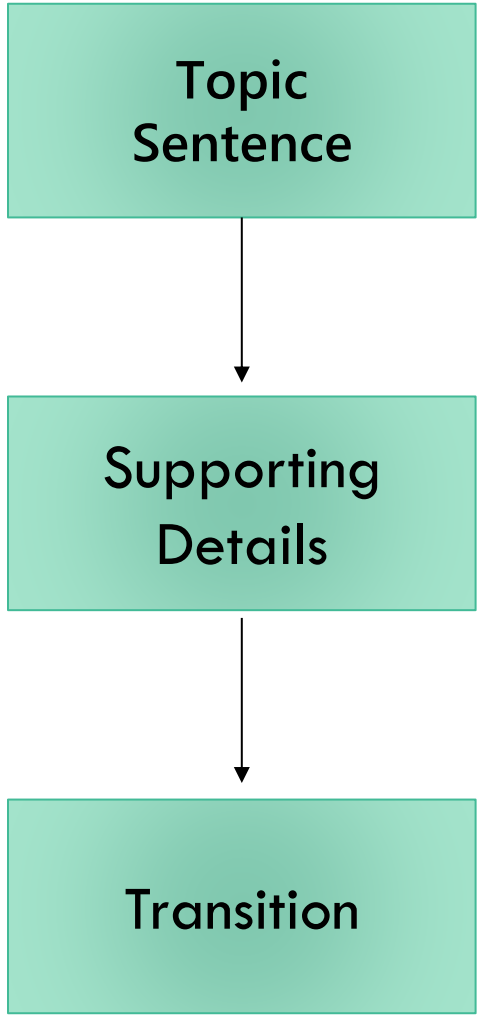
Functional English (SE-359)

INTRODUCTION

A paragraph consists of multiple sentences focused on a main idea or topic. Each sentence in the paragraph works together to support that main idea. Well-structured paragraphs make your writing easy to understand. Writing well-structured paragraphs can also go a long way in engaging readers.

PARAGRAPH STRUCTURE

Most paragraphs will follow a standard structure. Beginning with a topic sentence sets the stage for the rest of your content. The next part of the paragraph, consisting of multiple sentences, includes your supporting details. The last sentence functions as a transition to another paragraph or as a conclusion for a larger essay.



PARAGRAPH STRUCTURE



TOPIC SENTENCE



SUPPORTING DETAILS



TRANSITION

TOPIC SENTENCE

Topic sentences provide structure and clarity for a paragraph. A good topic sentence clearly states the paragraph's main idea, allowing readers to grasp the point quickly. In longer pieces of writing, such as essays or research papers, topic sentences play a crucial role in supporting the thesis statement because each topic sentence should relate directly to the thesis.

EXAMPLE TOPIC SENTENCES

Below are examples of topic sentences that might be used to begin paragraphs within an essay about the effects of climate change.

“Climate change shifts weather patterns, which leads to crop failures.”

“The melting of polar ice caps due to climate change is a threat to coastal communities.”

“Warmer global temperatures can intensify the spread of infectious diseases.”

SUPPORTING DETAILS

After the topic sentence, you will add several sentences that support and evaluate the main idea of your paragraph. There are two main types of supporting details.

These two types of details are evidence and analysis.

By including each type of supporting detail, you will have a fully developed paragraph that expresses your ideas in a way that readers will understand.

EVIDENCE

Effective supporting details often include evidence right after the topic sentence. Evidence refers to factual information that can support your claim or argument.

Evidence backs up your claims and makes your writing more convincing. The evidence that you present in your paragraph will frequently be information from an outside source.

TYPES OF EVIDENCE

- Statistics
- Anecdotes Case Studies
- Research Studies
- Expert Opinions
- Historical Evidence
- Logical
- Reasoning

ANALYSIS

After you present evidence, you will want to include your analysis. Analysis involves the examination and interpretation of evidence. In this section of the paragraph, you will draw conclusions and evaluate the significance of the evidence you previously presented. This section is where you explain why the evidence is important and how it relates to the main idea.

TRANSITIONS

Ending with a transition sentence smoothly connects one idea with the next one. Transitions help readers understand the relationship between the current paragraph and the upcoming one. The last sentence of the final paragraph of an essay acts as a transition by connecting the main ideas discussed in the essay to broader implications or future considerations.

PRACTICE ACTIVITY

- The role of art and music in education
- The impact of bullying and how to stop it
- A fictional character you admire.
- The impact of social media on teenagers
- The importance of recycling and reducing waste
- A memorable vacation or experience.